



Essential Toolkit & Templates

The **Core essential toolkit of a Business Analyst** that ensures clarity, alignment, and validation across the project lifecycle. The **lifecycle** of BA documentation:

- **BRD** defines the vision,
- **FRD** translates it into functions,
- **SRS** provides the technical blueprint,
- **Use Case Diagram** visualizes interactions,
- **User Story Template** drives Agile execution,
- **Traceability Matrix** validates coverage and closes the loop.



BRD – Business Requirements Document



Definition : A high-level document that captures the **business objectives, needs, and expected outcomes** of a project.

Purpose : Aligns stakeholders on what the business wants to achieve and why.

Contents :

- Project overview and goals
- Business problem statement
- Scope and constraints
- Stakeholder list
- Success criteria

Outcome : Serves as the foundation for all subsequent technical and functional documentation.

Summary :

1. Captures **business objectives, needs, and outcomes**.
2. Foundation for all subsequent documentation.
3. Flow → Leads into **FRD** for functional detail.



FRD – Functional Requirements Document

Definition : A detailed description of **how the system should function** to meet business needs.

Purpose : Translates business requirements into **functional specifications** for developers and testers.

Contents :

- Functional features and workflows
- Input/output specifications
- User interface requirements
- Data handling and validation rules

Outcome : Ensures technical teams understand exactly what to build and how it should behave.

Summary :

1. Defines **system functions and workflows**.
2. Translates business needs into technical specifications.
3. Flow → Supports **SRS** for technical architecture.



SRS – Software Requirements Specification

Definition : A comprehensive technical document outlining **system architecture, interfaces, and performance criteria**.

Purpose : Acts as a **contract between business and development teams**.

Contents :

- Functional and non-functional requirements
- System architecture and dependencies
- Data models and integration points
- Security and performance standards

Outcome : Provides developers and QA teams with a clear technical blueprint for implementation.

Summary :

1. Comprehensive **technical blueprint**.
2. Includes architecture, interfaces, performance, and security.
3. Flow → Guides **Use Case Diagrams** for visualization.



Use Case Diagram



Definition : A **visual representation** of how users (actors) interact with the system.

Purpose : Illustrates **system boundaries, user roles, and interactions**.

Components :

- Actors (users or external systems)
- Use cases (functional actions)
- Relationships (associations, extensions, inclusions)

Outcome : Simplifies communication between business and technical teams by visualizing functionality.

Summary :

1. Visualizes **actors, system boundaries, and interactions**.
2. Simplifies communication between business and IT.
3. Flow → Connects to **User Stories** for Agile execution.



User Story Template



Definition : A concise Agile artifact describing a **feature from the end-user's perspective**.

Format:

- “As a [user], I want [goal] so that [benefit].”

Purpose : Encourages collaboration and iterative development.

Outcome : Helps teams prioritize features and maintain user-centric focus during sprints.

Summary :

1. Agile artifact: “As a [user], I want [goal] so that [benefit].”
2. Keeps development **user-centric and iterative**.
3. Flow → Links into **Traceability Matrix** for validation.



Traceability Matrix

Definition : A table mapping **requirements to corresponding deliverables, test cases, and outcomes.**

Purpose : Ensures **complete coverage and validation** of all requirements throughout the project lifecycle.

Contents:

- Requirement ID
- Source document reference
- Design and test linkage
- Status tracking

Outcome : Provides transparency, accountability, and quality assurance.

Summary :

1. Maps **requirements to deliverables, test cases, and outcomes.**
2. Ensures **coverage, accountability, and quality assurance.**
3. Flow → Closes the loop back to BRD for alignment.

— These six documents form the **core toolkit of a Business Analyst**, enabling structured communication, traceability, and alignment between business goals and technical execution. Together, they ensure that every project is **well-defined, measurable, and successfully delivered.**



“ Project Scenario : Human Resource Management System (HRMS) “

[1.] Business Requirements Document (BRD) Template

Project Overview and Goals:

Implement a centralized HRMS to digitize traditional HR operations, reduce paperwork, improve payroll accuracy, and empower employees with self-service capabilities.

Business Problem Statement : The organization currently relies heavily on manual processes for employee records, recruitment, leave approvals, payroll, and performance evaluations, leading to inefficiencies, errors, and delays.

Scope and Constraints : Includes modules for employee records, recruitment, leave management, payroll, performance evaluation, and training.

Stakeholder List : Key stakeholders include the HR team, employees, IT department, and senior management.

Success Criteria : Achieve a 90% reduction in manual HR tasks within the first year, improve compliance with labor regulations, and enhance employee satisfaction through faster, more reliable services.

[2.] Functional Requirements Document (FRD) Template

Functional Features : Employee registration and profile management, recruitment module with job posting and applicant tracking, leave management with request/approval workflows, payroll calculation integrated with attendance, and performance appraisal forms and reports.

Workflows : Employee applies for leave $\rightarrow$ Manager approves $\rightarrow$ Payroll auto-updates.

Input/Output Specifications : Input data includes employee details, attendance logs, and leave requests. Outputs consist of payslips, performance reports, and HR dashboards.

Validation Rules : Employee ID must be unique, and leave requests cannot exceed available balances.



[3.] Software Requirements Specification (SRS) Template

System Architecture: Web-based HRMS with a secure database backend, web front-end, application server, and relational database.

Functional & Non-Functional Requirements:

Functional modules include recruitment, onboarding, leave management, payroll, performance evaluation, and training.

Non-functional requirements specify supporting at least 1,000 concurrent users, maintaining 99.9% uptime, and providing role-based access with encrypted data storage.

Data Models:

- Employee table (ID, name, department, role, salary).
- Leave table (ID, employee ID, type, balance, status).
- Payroll table (ID, employee ID, gross, deductions, net).

Integration Points: Connects to biometric attendance systems, email notifications, and accounting software.

[4.] Use Case Diagram Component Template

Actors: Employees, managers, HR staff, and external systems (biometric attendance system, accounting software).

Use Cases (Functional Actions): Register profile, submit leave request, approve leave, process payroll, conduct performance appraisal.

Relationships: Associations, extensions, and inclusions linking actors to system boundaries and functional actions.

[5.] User Story Template

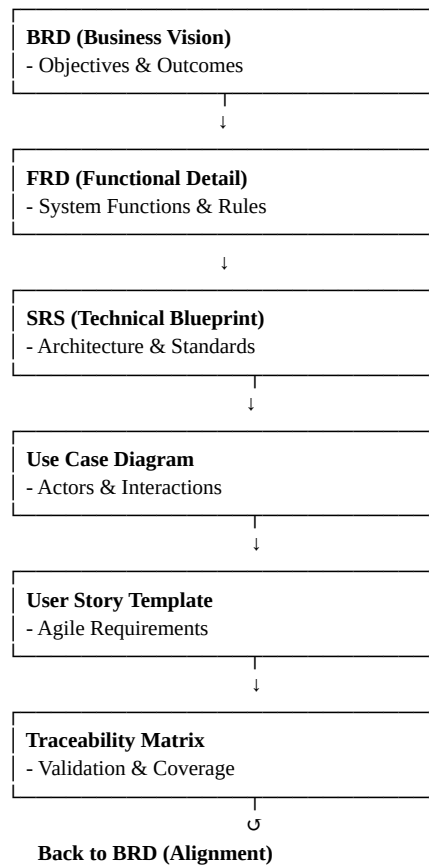
Format : "As a [user], I want [goal] so that [benefit]."

Sample HRMS User Story:

*As an **employee**, I want to **apply for leave through the self-service portal** so that **I can track my requests transparently without submitting physical paperwork**.*



Six-Module Flow Chart



✨ This six-module sequence shows how BA documentation progresses.